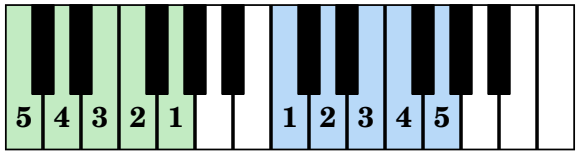
Unit 5

Loud and Soft

New: Dynamics: p, mp, mf, f; getting louder and softer

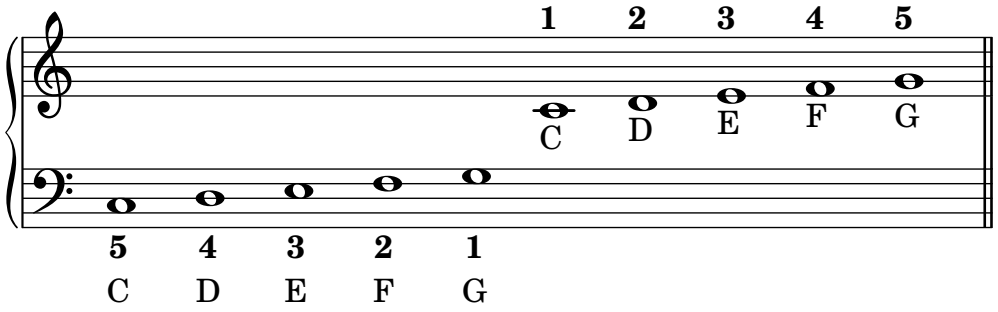
Music has loud and soft. Dynamics are the letters and signs that tell you how loudly to play. They are written below the staff, and each one lasts until the next.

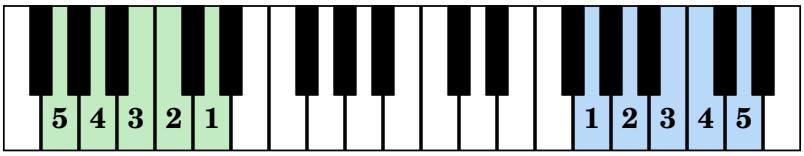


Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

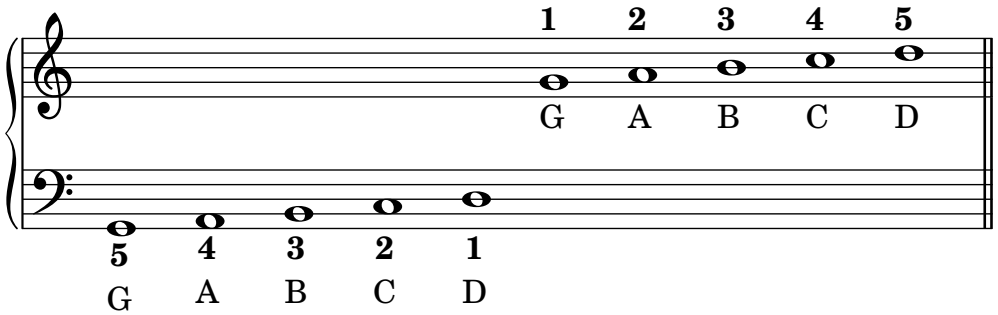




Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

p and f

p (piano) means soft; f (forte) means loud.

mp and mf

mp (mezzo piano) is medium soft; mf (mezzo forte) is medium loud. From soft to loud: p, mp, mf, f.

Hairpins

A widening wedge means get gradually louder (crescendo). A narrowing wedge means get gradually softer (diminuendo). Each leads to the next dynamic mark.

How to play louder

Use more arm weight and a quicker key stroke, not a harder finger. Soft playing still needs a full, clear sound.

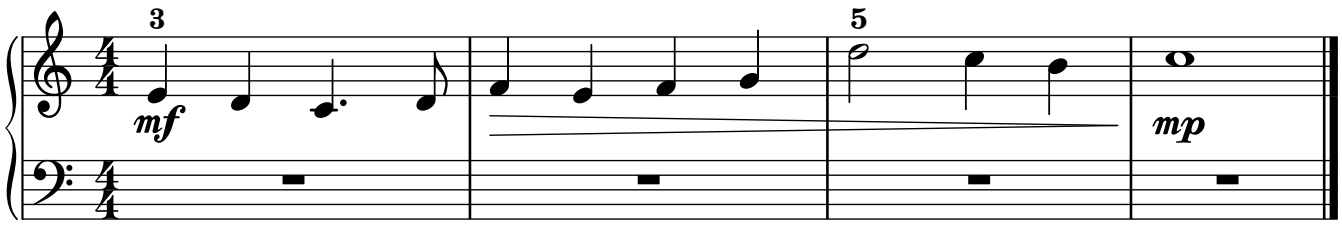
Reading tips

1. Find the first dynamic before you start, and set your sound before the first note.
2. A dynamic lasts until the next one. Keep it steady until the music asks for a change.
3. Make a crescendo gradual: start soft enough that there is room to grow.
4. Never let a dynamic change the tempo. Loud is not faster, and soft is not slower.

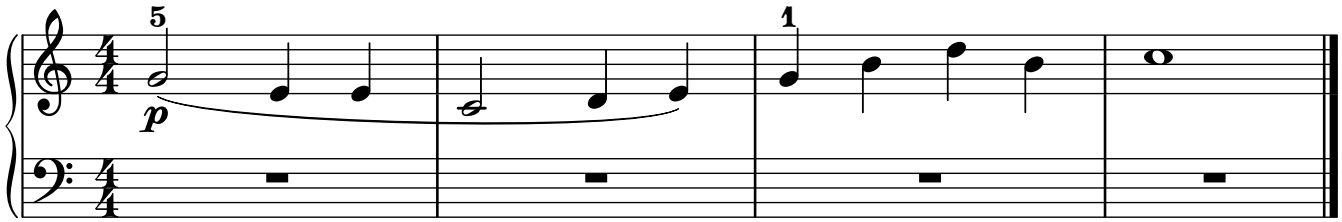
Part A: Dynamics, right hand ♩= 66

Dynamics in the right hand, with slurs, dots and shifts. Metronome 66.

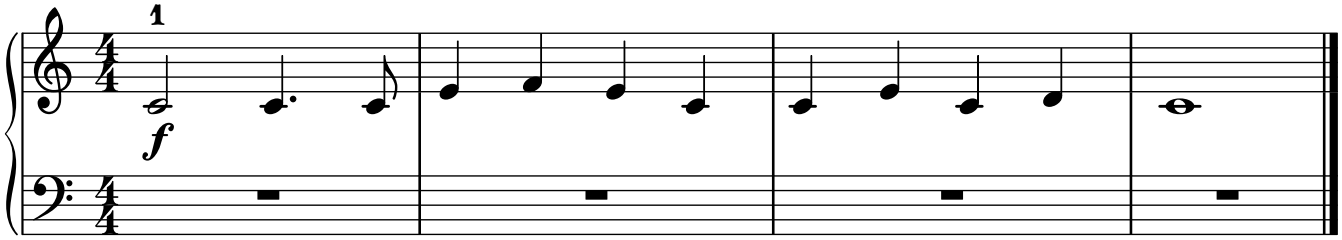
☐ **5.1**



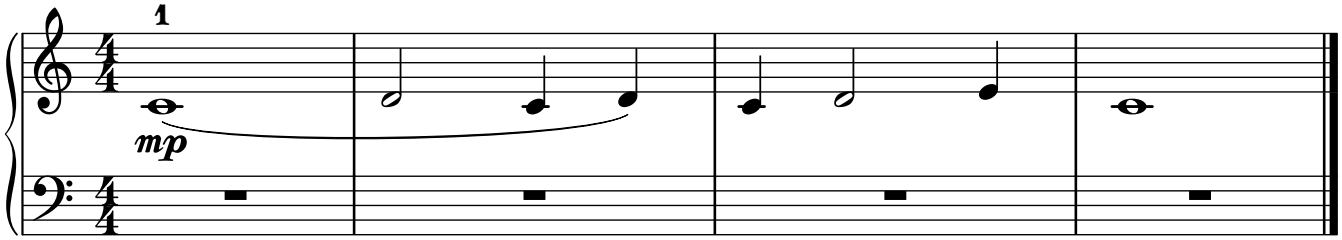
☐ **5.2**



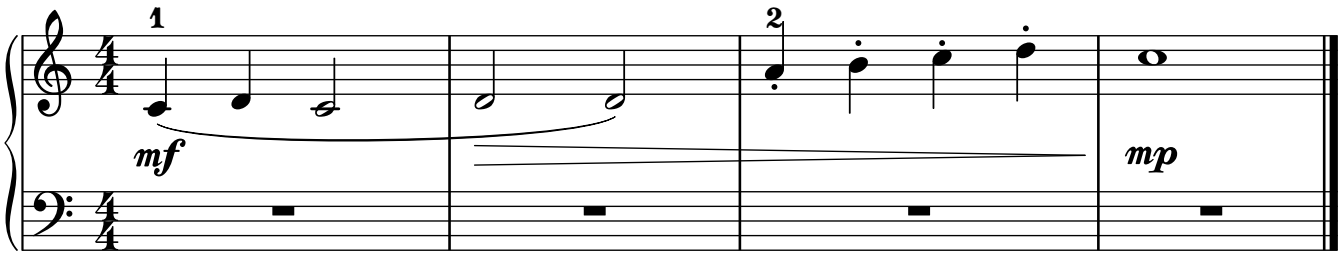
☐ **5.3**



☐ **5.4**



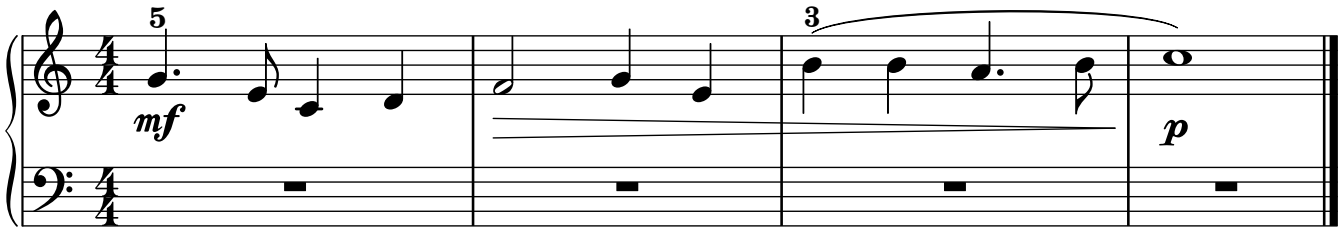
☐ **5.5**



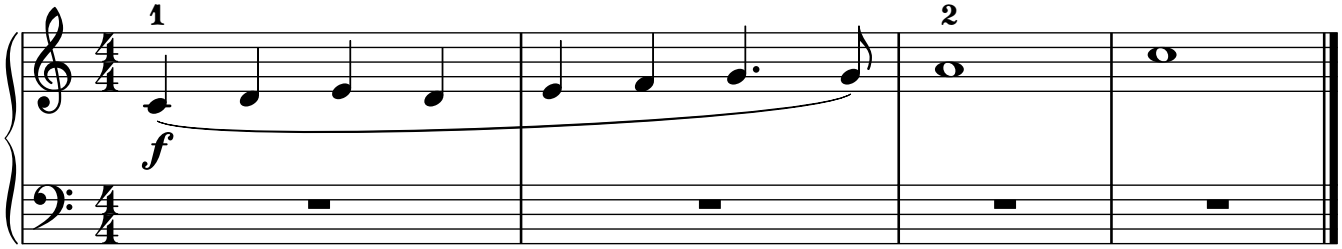
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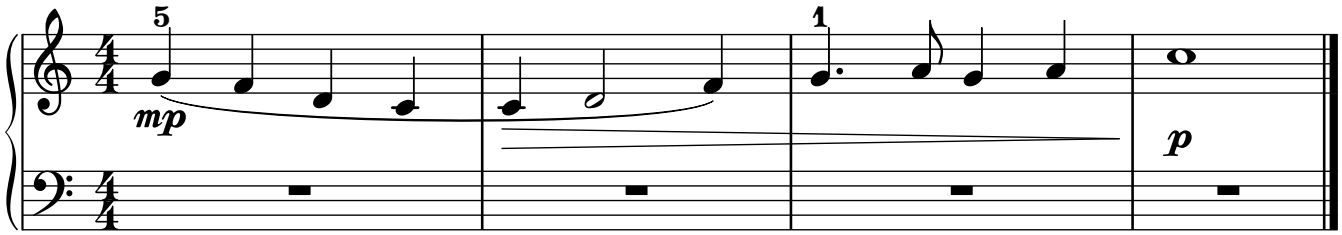
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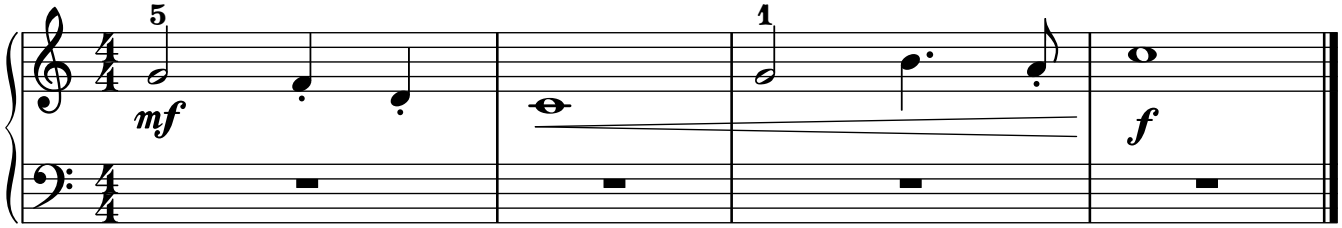
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5.9



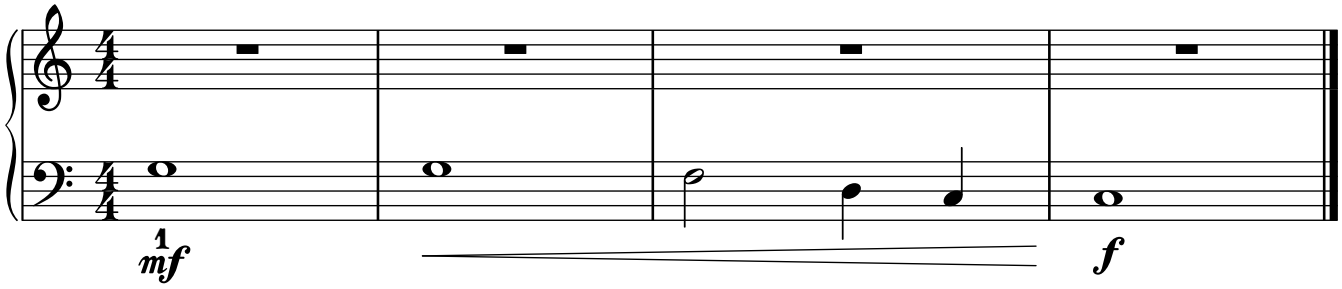
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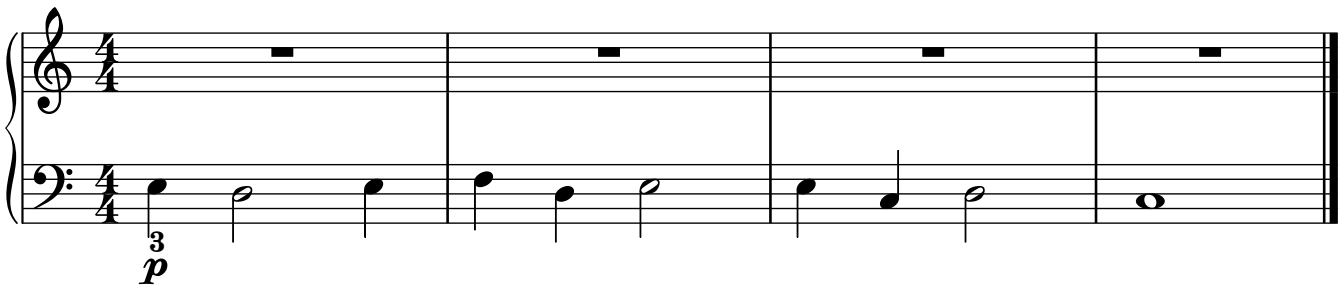
Part B: Dynamics, left hand ♩ = 66

Dynamics in the left hand.

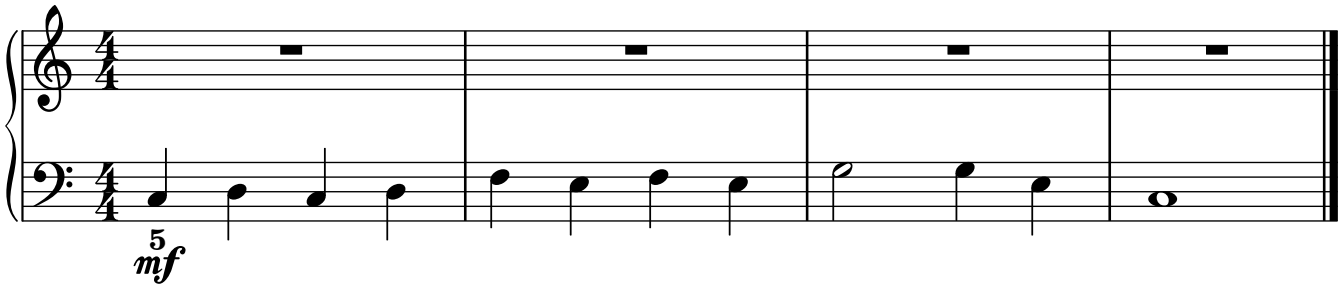
☐ **5.11**



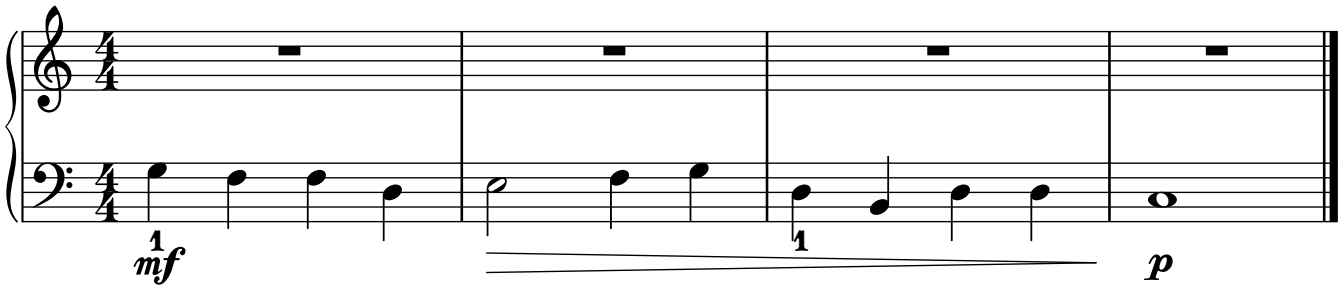
☐ **5.12**



☐ **5.13**



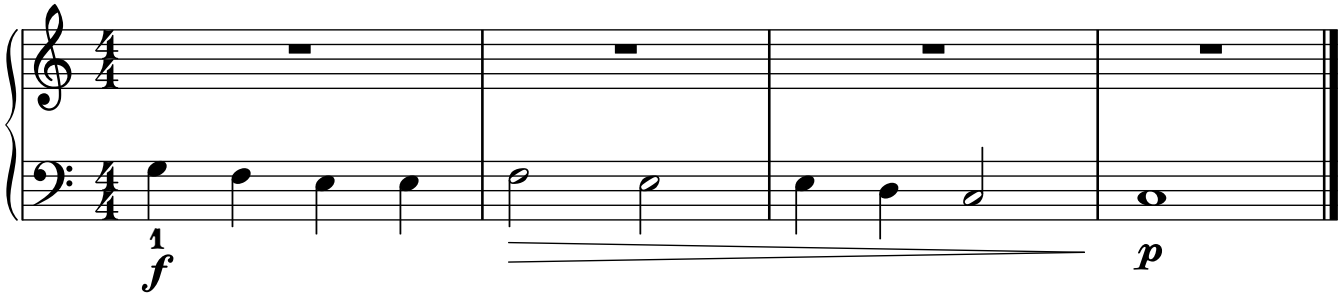
☐ **5.14**



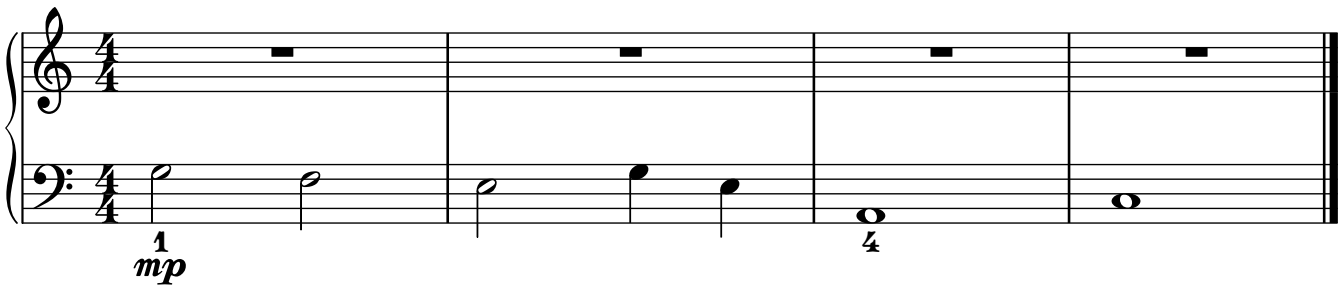
☐ **5.15**



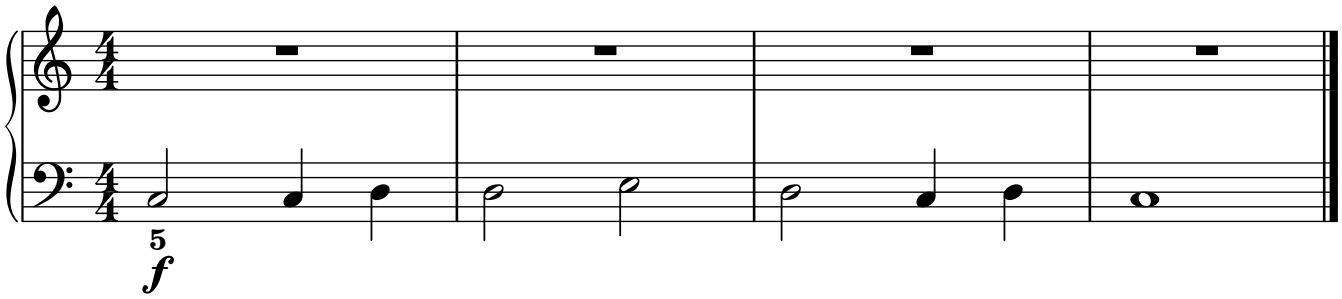
5.16



5.17



5.18



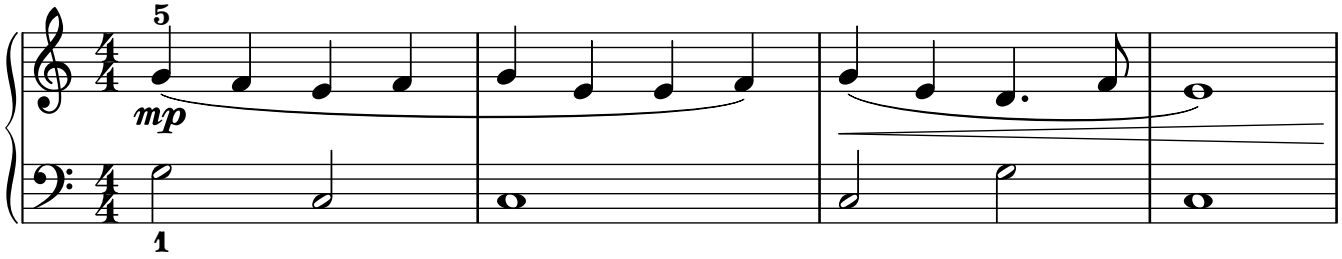
Part C: Shaping a phrase, hands together ♩ = 66

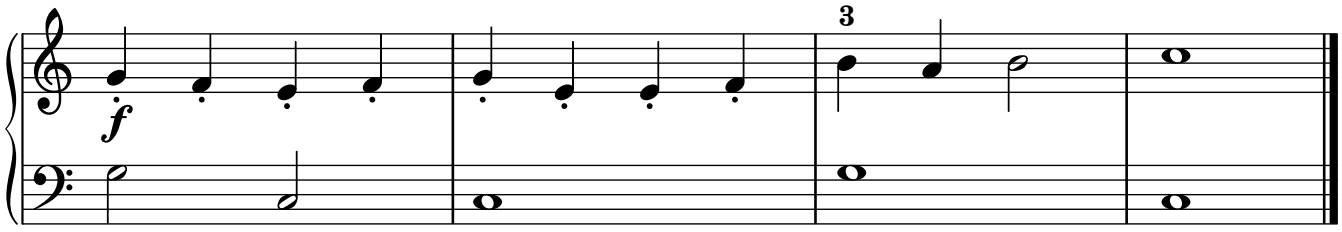
Shaping eight-bar phrases, hands together: one level, a hairpin, then a new level.

☐ **5.19**



☐ **5.20**





5.21



5.22



5.23



5.24



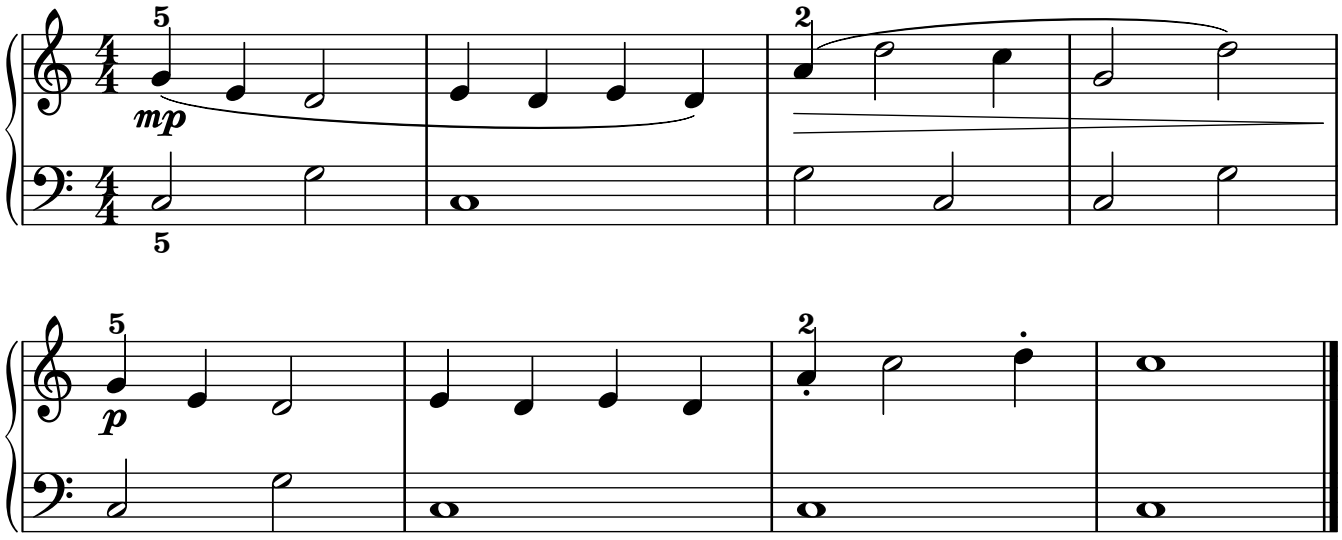
5.25



5.26



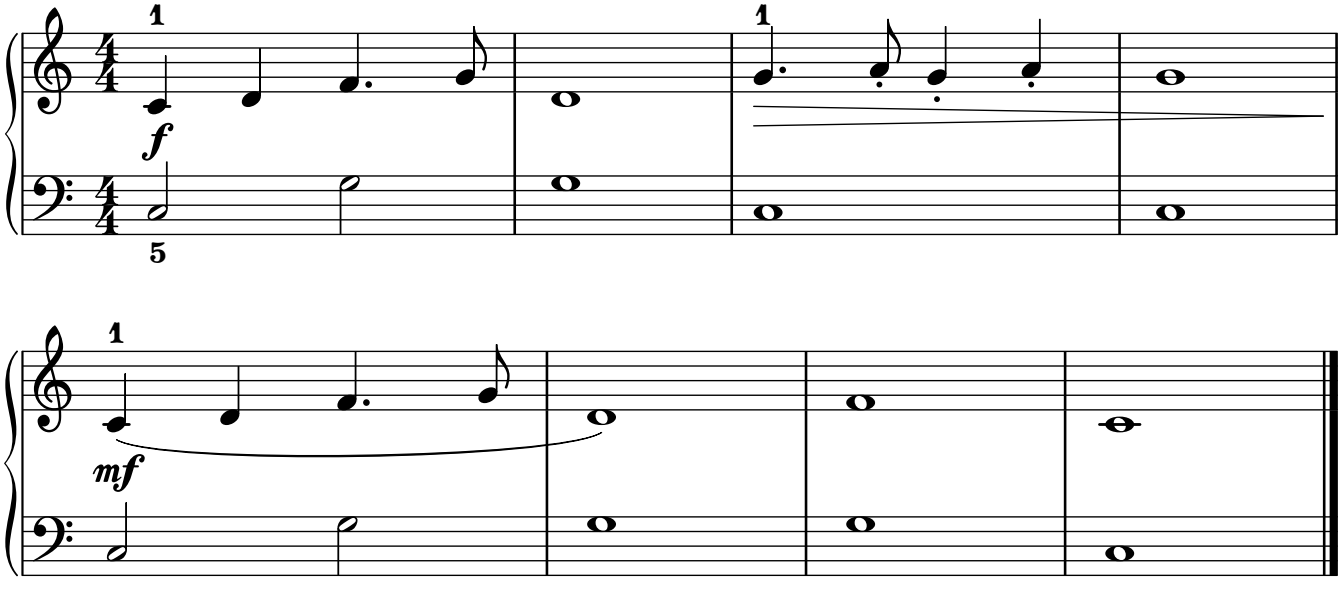
5.27



5.28



5.29



5.30



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Echo Valley ♩ = 76

Original

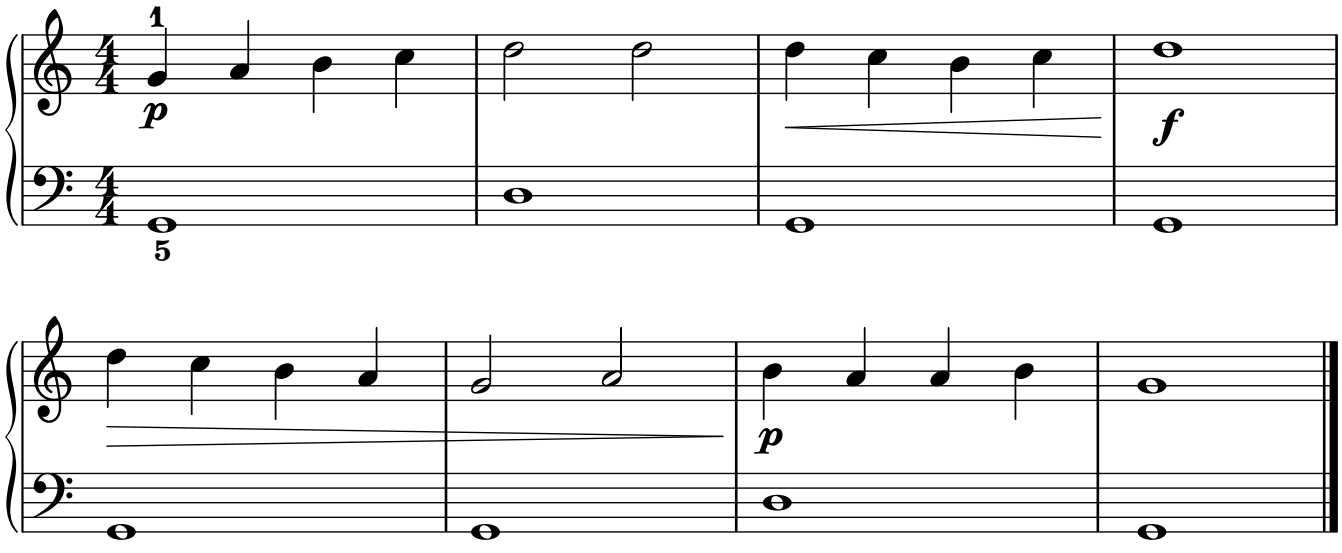
A loud call answered by a soft echo, then a crescendo to forte and a diminuendo to the end.



Storm and Calm ♩ = 72

Original

In G position. The storm builds to forte in bar 4, then calms down again.



Waltz in Waves ♩ = 84

Original

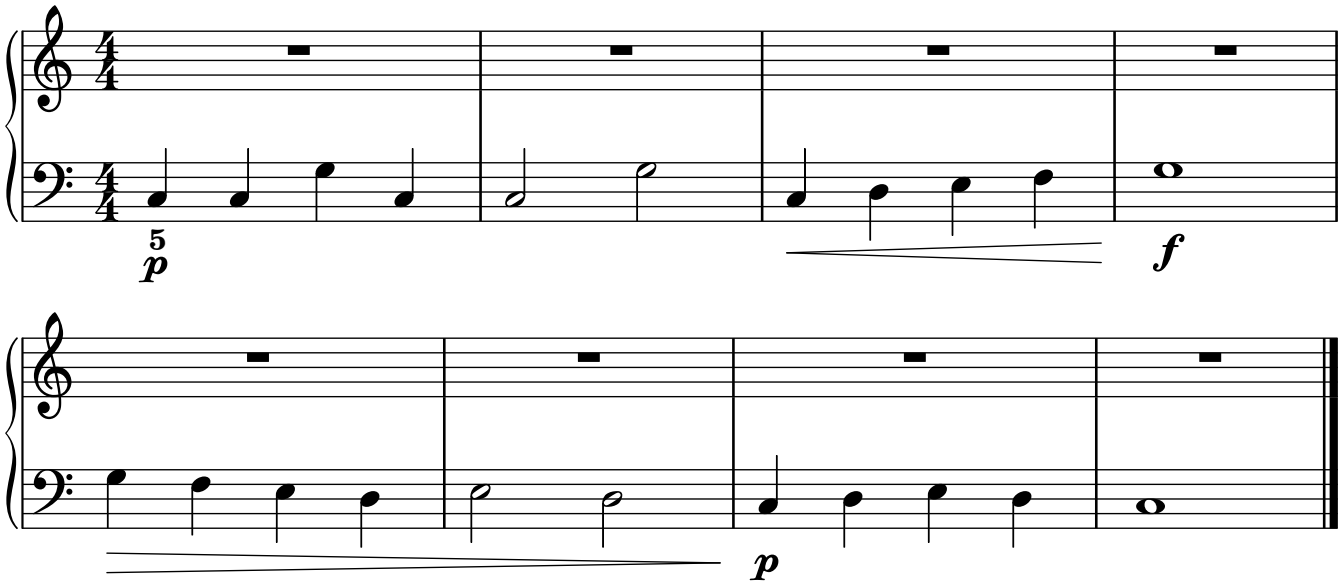
Each half of the waltz swells like a wave: grow towards bar 4, then fade towards the end.



Distant Drums ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone: drums approach (crescendo) and fade away (diminuendo).



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if a listener could hear every dynamic level and each crescendo or diminuendo.
- Pass if the tempo stays steady through every dynamic change, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6.